

John Wilson Cheek

jwcheek03@gmail.com

Raleigh, NC 27606 | 804-994-7360 | jwcheek03.github.io/portfolio/ | linkedin.com/in/jwcheek03

Education

B.S. Computer Science: Game Development Concentration | North Carolina State University, Raleigh, NC | May 2026

Minors: Creative Writing & English

Honors: Summa Cum Laude, University Honors Program, Dean's List, Bitzer Theatre Achievement Award

Relevant Coursework: Advanced Game Projects, Advanced Fiction Writing, Game Engine Foundations, Computer Graphics, Introduction to Artificial Intelligence, Communication for Engineering & Technology, C and Software Tools

Skills

Languages: Java, C, C++, C#, Python, HTML, CSS, Prolog, Unreal Engine Blueprints

Tools: Unreal Engine, Godot Engine, Visual Studio, GIT, Perforce, Jenkins, Notion, Adobe Suite, Office Suite

Project Experience

Lizard 101 | 1-3 Player card game developed in C++ using custom game engine functions

- Designed, implemented, and balanced fifty mechanically unique cards
- Emphasized synergies and interactions between the cards to create a dynamic gameplay experience

2D Game Engine | Custom 2D game engine developed in C++ using the SDL3 library

- Implemented core systems including networking, physics, input handling, and event management
- Applied software engineering best practices, including object-oriented design and memory management

Firechess | Serious strategy game developed in Unreal Engine 5.7 using C++ and blueprints

- Implemented core mechanics and features with C++ and integrated Blueprint Scripting for interactive elements
- Worked with a 5-person team to create a turn-based experience that simulates wildfire fighting

The Impossible Winter | RPG created in Unreal Engine 5.6 using C++ and blueprints

- Translated the world and story of my writing into mechanics that reflect the story's narrative
- Designed and prototyped a large open world using UE landscape, foliage, and modeling tools

The Broken Kingdom | Top-down RPG developed in Godot Engine

- Collaborated with a four-person team to design game mechanics and identify desired player experiences
- Conceptualized the game's narrative and wrote over 100 lines of story related non-player character dialogue

The Deep End | Adventure game developed in Godot Engine for Triangle Game Jam 2026

- Designed, developed, and play-tested alongside a team of 5 within a strict 1-week time frame
- Grey-boxed levels and iterated with 3D artists to create an explorable, readable and exciting play space

Work Experience

Event Coordinator | North Carolina State University Theatre | Raleigh, NC

Sep 2022 – Present

- Communicated between clients, house crews, and student crews to achieve the client's vision for an event
- Adapted to real-time changes and issues during live performances and instructed crew members how to respond

Stage Manager | North Carolina State University Theatre | Raleigh, NC

Sep 2024 – Jun 2025

- Served as the central communication point between the director, show designers, and over 50 company members
- Managed scheduling, cue timing, and rehearsal documentation across 550 cumulative hours of productions

Research Assistant | North Carolina State University | Raleigh, NC

Nov 2024 – Feb 2025

- Gathered and analyzed research survey results from 122 industry professionals at over 24 companies
- Categorized data points into 21 key competencies and 10 factors that describe effective product managers

Campus Involvement

Video Game Development Club | Club Member | Raleigh, NC

Sep 2025 – Present

Alpha Psi Omega– Psi Kappa Cast | Fundraising Committee Member | Raleigh, NC

Feb 2025 – Present